

5.2.1 Social Psychology

The primary concern of social psychologists is to understand behaviour in a social context and the ways in which the social context can influence behaviour.



Social Influence

Candidates should:

- be able to define conformity and demonstrate some knowledge of research studies e.g. the work of Asch;
- be able to define obedience and demonstrate some knowledge of research studies e.g. the work of Milgram;
- demonstrate knowledge of factors affecting levels of obedience and conformity;
- be able to evaluate the research on conformity and obedience including possible cultural differences.



Environment and Behaviour

Candidates should:

- be able to define the concept of personal space and demonstrate a knowledge of studies regarding the invasion of personal space e.g. the work of Garfinkel or Felipe and Sommer;
- consider possible cross-cultural and gender differences regarding personal space;
- be able to define territory as well as demonstrate a knowledge of different types of territory and the concept of defensible space e.g. the work of Altman;
- demonstrate knowledge of the ways in which an individual might establish and protect their personal space and territory e.g. the work of Sommer.